

Mac and Cheese



Recipe courtesy of Ina Garten

Show: Barefoot Contessa Episodes: Like a Kid in the Candy Store and What Are Friends For?

From: Barefoot Contessa Family Style



Level: Easy

Yield: 6 to 8 servings

Ingredients:

Kosher salt

Vegetable oil

1 pound elbow macaroni or cavatappi

1 quart milk (3 cups milk / 1 cup white wine)

8 tablespoons (1 stick) unsalted butter, divided

1/2 cup all-purpose flour

12 ounces Gruyere, grated (4 cups)

8 ounces extra-sharp Cheddar, grated (2 cups)

1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper

1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg

3/4 pound fresh tomatoes (4 small)

1 1/2 cups fresh white bread crumbs (5 slices, crusts removed)

1 tspn dijon

Directions:

1 Preheat the oven to 375 degrees F.

2 Drizzle oil into a large pot of boiling salted water. Add the macaroni and cook according to the directions on the package, 6 to 8 minutes. Drain well.

3 Meanwhile, heat the milk in a small saucepan, but don't boil it. Melt 6 tablespoons of butter in a large (4-quart) pot and add the flour. Cook over low heat for 2 minutes, stirring with a whisk. While whisking, add the hot milk and cook for a minute or two more, until thickened and smooth. Off the heat, add the Gruyere, Cheddar, 1 tablespoon salt, dijon, pepper, and nutmeg. Add the cooked macaroni and stir well. Pour into a 3-quart baking dish.

4 Slice the tomatoes and arrange on top. Melt the remaining 2 tablespoons of butter, combine them with the fresh bread crumbs, and sprinkle on the top. Bake for 30 to 35 minutes, or until the sauce is bubbly and the macaroni is browned on the top.



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NOTE: TO FREEZE: Cool to Room Temp. Cover well with heavy foil.
(do not top with bread crumbs before freezing)

Thaw Mac-n-cheese overnight in frig, Then top with Bread crumbs & bake.

(No tomatoes, just preference.)

* or make day ahead & put in frig overnight. Rest 30 min on counter before baking

(sub 1/4 cup white wine for same amount of milk?)